SIXFOLD LLC · INTERNAL — OPERATIONS

Who Pays for Mitigation

Every route a Colorado property owner has to get money back on fire-mitigation work — tax, insurance, county cost-share, state and federal grants — with the catch on each one spelled out.

Prepared **2026-09-08** · revised **2026-10-02** Base **Monument, CO**

Every figure to be re-verified before it is quoted to a client

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WHY THIS DOCUMENT EXISTS

Every competitor sells the work. Almost nobody explains the money. Four kinds of party will pay toward fire mitigation and most homeowners know about none of them — the state's own evaluation of the tax credit found fewer than half of surveyed landowners had ever heard of it. If Sixfold is the crew that shows up understanding what the client can claim, that is a real advantage a new company can hold without out-crediting a veteran outfit. **This is a briefing for the office and the crew, not a customer handout, and nothing in it is tax or legal advice to give a client.**

THE ONE RULE THAT GOVERNS ALL OF THIS — THE STACKING LIMIT

The Colorado state income tax credit **explicitly excludes any cost that was paid from, or reimbursed by, a grant or incentive.** So a homeowner who gets Douglas County to cover 50% of a $20,000 job can claim the state credit only against *their own* $10,000 — not the county's half. The programs below combine, but they do not double-dip: grant money and the tax credit cannot both land on the same dollar. Say “these can often be combined” and stop there; let the client's accountant do the arithmetic.

At a glance

Tiers run from most universal to most specialised. “Paid to” matters for how a job is invoiced: `owner` means the client is reimbursed and pays Sixfold in full up front; `contractor` means the program pays Sixfold directly for its share; `entity` means an HOA, district or nonprofit is the applicant and Sixfold is their hired contractor.

PROGRAM	WHO RUNS IT	COVERS	CEILING	PAID TO	WHERE
`TIER 1` **State wildfire-mitigation income tax credit**	CO Dept of Revenue	100% of contractor costs for defensible space, fuel breaks, thinning, slash treatment	$1,000 (2025–26) → $2,000 (2027–30)	`owner`	Any private CO land

PROGRAM	WHO RUNS IT	COVERS	CEILING	PAID TO	WHERE
TIER 1 **Insurance mitigation discount**	Each insurer (per HB25-1182)	Premium reduction for documented defensible space / home hardening	No set rate — varies by carrier	owner	Statewide, from 1 Jul 2026
TIER 2 **Douglas County Wildfire Mitigation Cost-Share**	Douglas County	50% match on defensible space, fuel reduction; community projects; chipping	$25,000 home · $50,000 community · $7,500 chipping	contractor	Douglas County
TIER 2 **COSWAP landowner cost-share**	CO DNR / CSFS, via Wildfire Adapted Partnership	Up to 50% of a mitigation project after a free risk assessment	Set per parcel by the assessment	owner	Mapped COSWAP areas
TIER 2 **Wildfire Partners rebate**	Boulder County	Labor and cash costs of eligible mitigation actions	$500 per household	owner	Boulder County
TIER 2 **Grand County Wildfire Council cost-share**	Grand County Wildfire Council	Home hardening + first-5-ft + vent screening (a separate fuels pot exists)	$1,000 per property, or 50%, whichever is less	owner	Grand County
TIER 2 **Eagle County REALFire cost-share**	Eagle County	Portion of defensible space / home hardening tied to a REALFire assessment	Set per assessment	owner	Eagle County
TIER 2 **WAP Defensible Space Cost Share**	Wildfire Adapted Partnership	Partial reimbursement after a HIZ assessment and completed work	Set per parcel; not published	owner	SW Colorado grant geography
TIER 2 **Routt County corridor cost-share**	Routt County OEM + Wildfire Mitigation Council	50% reimbursement, prioritised along evacuation corridors	Pooled ~$120k county-wide in 2026	owner	Routt County
TIER 3 **CSFS Forest Restoration & Wildfire Risk Mitigation (FRWRM)**	Colorado State Forest Service	Landscape fuels reduction, thinning, slash disposal, capacity building	Share of ~$7.04M; 1:1 match (25% match in under-resourced areas)	entity	Statewide, WUI
TIER 3 **USFS Community Wildfire Defense Grant (CWDG)**	US Forest Service, via CSFS	CWPP writing + implementation; can fund homeowner defensible-space incentives	Large multi-year awards	entity	At-risk communities
TIER 3 **FEMA Hazard Mitigation Assistance (HMGP / BRIC)**	FEMA, via CO DHSEM + local govt	Coordinated defensible space across many parcels; fuel breaks	Program-dependent	entity	Post-disaster (HMGP) / competitive (BRIC)
TIER 4 **NRCS EQIP**	USDA Natural Resources Conservation Service	Brush management, fuel breaks, forest stand improvement, thinning on working land	Per CO practice payment schedule	owner	Ag / non-industrial private forest land

PROGRAM	WHO RUNS IT	COVERS	CEILING	PAID TO	WHERE
TIER 4 **CSFS Forest Ag property-tax classification**	Colorado State Forest Service + county assessor	Agricultural tax valuation for managed forest land — not a rebate	Ongoing lower property tax	owner	40+ forested acres, statewide

TIER 1 Available to almost any Colorado owner

These two do not care which county the property sits in. They are the universal story to tell every client, and the only ones Sixfold can reliably point to on a first visit anywhere in the state.

Colorado wildfire-mitigation measures income tax credit

COLORADO DEPARTMENT OF REVENUE · C.R.S. 39-22-543 · CLAIMED ON **DR 0104CR** WITH THE DR 0104

A state income-tax credit for what a landowner pays a contractor to reduce wildfire risk on their own private Colorado land. Since August 2024 (HB24-1036) **only costs paid to a third-party contractor qualify** — a homeowner buying or renting equipment to do it themselves does not. The four qualifying measures must meet or exceed Colorado State Forest Service or Division of Fire Prevention & Control standards: creating defensible space around structures; establishing fuel breaks; thinning woody vegetation for the primary purpose of reducing risk to structures; and secondary treatment of the resulting fuels by lopping and scattering, piling, chipping, removing from the site, or prescribed burning. That list is Sixfold's core work almost line for line.

AMOUNT	**Tax year 2025:** 100% of qualifying cost, capped at **$1,000**, for filers with federal taxable income at or below $129,200. **2026:** same 100% / $1,000; the income limit for 2026 is *not yet published* by Revenue. **2027–2030:** cap rises to **$2,000**, income test becomes **AGI at or below $300,000**, and the excess over tax liability becomes **refundable** (paid out even if larger than the bill). Before 2027 any excess is simply lost — not refunded, not carried forward.
ELIGIBLE OWNER	Owner of record of private CO land — fee, easement, right-of-way, or a **recorded** lease. Held solely, jointly or in common, but **only one individual of an ownership group may claim.** Public land never qualifies. There is **no wildland-urban-interface test** — the credit says only "real property located in Colorado".
DOES NOT COVER	Property purchase price; the landowner's own equipment purchase or rental; inspection or certification fees; in-kind or donated work; cost-sharing between neighbours; and **any cost paid from or reimbursed by a grant or incentive**.
HOW CLAIMED	The homeowner files it themselves on DR 0104CR with their return, with copies of receipts attached or uploaded through Revenue Online. There is no state form Sixfold submits.
NEW FOR 2027	A separate, narrower category — "infestation mitigation measures": thinning of woody vegetation at risk of or killed by mountain pine beetle or spruce beetle. This is an *addition*, not a broadening of the existing thinning line.

WHAT SIXFOLD DOES WITH IT

Supply an itemised invoice that separates qualifying mitigation work from anything non-qualifying, plus a written statement of the standard the crew worked to. **Never say "we handle the paperwork for you"** and never file or prepare a return — that reads as tax preparation. The eligibility questions to settle before work starts (who is the owner of record, which one person in a group is claiming, is any grant money covering part of the bill) are already on Form A of the tax-credit notebook.

Insurance premium discount for documented mitigation

EACH ADMITTED INSURER · COLORADO **HB25-1182**, EFFECTIVE 1 JULY 2026 · DOI REGULATION 5-1-28 (3 CCR 702-5)

Colorado law now requires an insurer that uses a wildfire risk model or score to send each policyholder an **annual written disclosure** of their property's wildfire risk score, the mitigation discounts available, and how mitigation is factored into pricing — plus a **right to appeal** the score. Where a carrier's model does not already credit a property's mitigation, the carrier must apply a discount when the owner documents it. The law **does not set a discount percentage**; it varies by carrier filing, and no regulator dictates the number.

AMOUNT	Carrier-specific. Do not put a percentage in front of a client — there isn't one to quote.
WHAT COUNTS	Documented defensible space and home-hardening actions. Score notices are landing on Colorado properties now; a client may already be holding one.
REGULATION DETAIL	*Revised 2026-10-02, from the Division's draft text of Reg 5-1-28; the adopted version may differ in detail, and its effective date is reported inconsistently (14 Feb vs 1 Oct 2026), so none is given.* Applies to admitted insurers and the FAIR Plan, not non-admitted carriers. An insurer that gives mitigation discounts must post them, **with amounts**, on its public website, or post that it gives none. Evidence of completed mitigation must be reviewed and the score updated (or a written reason given) within **30 days**; appeals acknowledged in 10 days and decided in 30. Evidence an insurer will consider includes **receipts and photos** and **letters, reports or certifications from mitigation contractors**.
BACKSTOP	If a property is non-renewed and no carrier will write it, the **Colorado FAIR Plan** (launched April 2025) offers up to $750,000 of residential coverage on an actual-cash-value basis — a last resort, not a target.

WHAT SIXFOLD DOES WITH IT

The photograph log and dated before/after record (Form D of the notebook) is built for exactly this. Sixfold assembles the documentation package and can help the owner draft a re-score request; it does **not** contact the insurer, promise a lower premium, or put a number on any discount.

TIER 2 County and regional cost-share — depends where the property is

These pay a percentage of the actual mitigation work, but only inside their boundary and usually only after a required risk assessment. Most reimburse the homeowner after the job is done and paid in full; Douglas County is the exception that pays the contractor directly. Nearly all are first-come until the season's money runs out.

Douglas County Wildfire Mitigation Cost-Share Program

DOUGLAS COUNTY BUILDING DIVISION / WILDFIRE MITIGATION · DOUGLAS.CO.US/BUILDING-DIVISION/WILDFIRE-MITIGATION

The strongest county program in Sixfold's service area, and the one already flagged as a business priority. A **50% financial match** for work that creates defensible space, reduces vegetation density, and breaks up fuel continuity.

AMOUNT — **Up to $25,000** to a homeowner (50% match). **Up to $50,000** for a community project. **Up to $7,500** for community chipping or slash pickup.

TO APPLY — A detailed scope of work, a site map, and **a minimum of two contractor bids, "preferably" from the county's list**. *Revised 2026-10-02:* the county's August 2026 list states *"Residents may choose any qualified contractor to complete eligible work"* and strongly encourages its **Preferred** Contractor List (28 companies; Sixfold is not on it). A coordinated site visit with applicant and contractor comes before approval.

TIMING — **The 2026 application period is closed** (county page, read 2026-10-02); awards are notified in the fall and the next round is not announced. 2026 ran a spring window (~13 April – 13 May) and a later one. Work starts only after the award agreement is signed; awardees then have 10 months to complete.

PAYMENT — On completion, county staff inspect the property. The homeowner pays the contractor their (owner) share; once the owner submits the final invoice and proof of payment, **Douglas County Finance releases the 50% match directly to the contractor**.

WHAT SIXFOLD DOES WITH IT

Revised 2026-10-02: the list is preferred, not required. Sixfold can be one of a homeowner's two bids today, so the program can be named to a Douglas County client — as the county's program, with the round's status stated, and **never** with a claim that Sixfold is on the list. Getting onto the Preferred Contractor List is still worth doing: the county steers residents to it.

Colorado Strategic Wildfire Action Program (COSWAP) — landowner cost-share

COLORADO DEPARTMENT OF NATURAL RESOURCES / CSFS · DELIVERED BY WILDFIRE ADAPTED PARTNERSHIP (WAP)

State-funded cost-share for private landowners inside a **mapped COSWAP program area**. The owner books a free home wildfire risk assessment through WAP, tells the assessor they want the COSWAP grant, hires a contractor, completes the work, and is then reimbursed **up to 50%** of the project. (COSWAP also runs large workforce-development grants — $6.9M to 24 projects in February 2026 — but those fund youth corps and inmate fire crews, not homeowner work.)

AMOUNT — Up to 50%, set per parcel by the assessment (home-site size, vegetation, terrain).

CATCH — Only inside the mapped area, and the assessment must come first — work started before the award letter is signed is not covered.

WHERE — Program maps shift each cycle; WAP and the county emergency-management office confirm whether a given address is in.

WHAT SIXFOLD DOES WITH IT

Ask the client whether they have had a WAP or COSWAP assessment; if not and they are rural, point them at it before the crew is scheduled, because the timing rule is strict.

Wildfire Partners — Boulder County

BOULDER COUNTY · WILDFIREPARTNERS.ORG

Wildfire Partners is best known for its **assessment and certification** (the certificate is what several insurers want to see). Its cash side is now a **rebate, not a large cost-share**: up to **$500 per Boulder County household** for labor and cash costs of eligible mitigation actions, one per property, first-come until the pot is empty. A parallel multi-family program offers up to $500 per unit for common-area work. 2026 application deadline is **8 October 2026**; roughly $1.625M is budgeted across the rebate programs.

WHAT SIXFOLD DOES WITH IT

Small money, but the certification is the real prize for a Boulder-area client's insurance file. The City of Boulder runs a separate Wildfire Resilience Assistance Program (WRAP) for properties inside city limits — confirm which applies.

Grand County Wildfire Council — cost-share

GRAND COUNTY WILDFIRE COUNCIL · BEWILDFIREREADY.ORG

A **Home Hardening Cost Share** reimbursing the lesser of **$1,000 per property or 50% of cost**, after the project is complete and fully paid, first-come. Covers home hardening plus the first five feet (gravel and landscape fabric) and vent screening to ⅛-inch metal mesh. An HIZ assessment with the Council or a fire district is required first. A separate **Fuels Reduction Cost-Share** also exists for tree thinning and defensible space — confirm current terms with the Council.

WHAT SIXFOLD DOES WITH IT

Middle Park is outside Sixfold's stated service area, but the structure — assessment first, homeowner bids, reimbursement after full payment — is the pattern most Colorado county programs follow.

Eagle County — REALFire cost-share

EAGLE COUNTY · REALFIRE.NET

A free REALFire property assessment by trained fire professionals **may qualify the owner for a cost-share grant** covering a portion of the mitigation work identified. Property owners acting on REALFire assessments have drawn more than $250,000 in cost-share awards to date; the county's goal is 750 assessed homes by 2028.

WHAT SIXFOLD DOES WITH IT

Same assessment-gated pattern; the award size is set by the assessment, so there is no headline number to quote.

Wildfire Adapted Partnership — Defensible Space Cost Share & Chipper Rebate

WILDFIRE ADAPTED PARTNERSHIP (WAP) · WILDFIREADAPTED.ORG · SOUTHWEST COLORADO

WAP is the delivery partner for COSWAP and for its own **Defensible Space Cost Share** across a southwest-Colorado grant geography (Archuleta, La Plata, Montezuma and neighbouring counties, varying by cycle). Free HIZ assessment first, a signed award letter **before** any contractor work, then a partial reimbursement to the homeowner after the job is completed and paid in full — the amount set by home-site size, vegetation and terrain. A separate **Chipper Rebate** offsets the cost of chipping slash.

WHAT SIXFOLD DOES WITH IT

Outside the current service area, but the model to understand: one nonprofit runs both the state (COSWAP) and regional cost-share through a single assessment.

Larimer County — Community Mitigation Grant

LARIMER COUNTY OFFICE OF EMERGENCY MANAGEMENT

Not an individual-homeowner program. Funds neighbourhoods, HOAs, and local nonprofits for hazardous-fuels reduction, community chipping and slash removal, firewood banks, and equipment. 2026 saw record demand; the performance period for 2026 projects ends 2 November 2026. Larimer also runs a Wildfire Partner Program (Sheriff's Office) that does assessments.

WHAT SIXFOLD DOES WITH IT

This is a Tier-3-style pattern at county scale: the money goes to an `entity`, and Sixfold's route in is being the contractor an HOA hires with the grant.

Routt County — evacuation-corridor cost-share

ROUTT COUNTY OFFICE OF EMERGENCY MANAGEMENT + ROUTT COUNTY WILDFIRE MITIGATION COUNCIL

Landowners along priority evacuation corridors pay for hazardous-fuels work up front and receive **50% reimbursement** through state (FRWRM) grant funds, letting the county extend treatment past public rights-of-way. 2026 budget was up to ~$120,000 county-wide, half state-reimbursed, plus a $10,000 Council contribution.

WHAT SIXFOLD DOES WITH IT

Corridor-prioritised and pooled — a client's eligibility depends on where their driveway meets the road, not just the county line.

Summit County — free chipping and CWPP grants

SUMMIT COUNTY GOVERNMENT / CSU EXTENSION FOREST HEALTH

Summit County does **not** run a homeowner defensible-space cash cost-share. It provides **free chipping and haul-away** of slash piles (trees, logs, branches up to 12 in diameter, no willows) on a neighbourhood-week schedule, and free fire-district home assessments. Its CWPP Grant Program makes matching grants for life-safety, critical-infrastructure, evacuation-route and education projects — not routine defensible space.

WHAT SIXFOLD DOES WITH IT

The free chipping changes the disposal math for a Summit job (see the disposal directory), and it means a Summit client's “money back” is the state credit and insurance, not a county cheque.

El Paso & Teller counties — what actually exists

SIXFOLD'S HOME TURF — AND THE THINNEST COUNTY-MONEY PICTURE IN THE SERVICE AREA

No confirmed standing homeowner cost-share was found for El Paso County as of this research. The routes for an El Paso or Teller client are the state tax credit, the insurance discount, EQIP if the land is rural/agricultural, and whatever homeowner incentives local fire districts stand up with grant money. Teller County's Coalition for the Upper South Platte (CUSP) runs free/low-cost slash sites and neighbourhood chipping (homeowner-facing — see the disposal directory) and CSFS administers cost-share for larger projects in that watershed. **Confirm directly** with El Paso County Community Services / Environmental Division, and with Black Forest Fire, Tri-Lakes-Monument Fire and the Woodland Park / Teller districts, whether any current CWDG- or FRWRM-funded rebate is running.

Re-checked 2026-10-02: still none found. Teller County and Woodland Park's **$1M COSWAP grant** funds a buffer zone protecting Woodland Park's utilities and infrastructure — it has no homeowner component. **HB26-1310**, which would have funded home-hardening grants for homeowners, was postponed indefinitely on 23 March 2026.

WHAT SIXFOLD DOES WITH IT

For the counties Sixfold works most, lead every client conversation with Tier 1. Do not imply an El Paso County cheque exists until one is confirmed by name.

Jefferson County — homeowner incentives, emerging

JEFFERSON COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE

In July 2026 the Jefferson County Sheriff's Office was awarded a **$9.67M USFS Community Wildfire Defense Grant**, a five-year award that will fund mitigation staff, equipment, roadside vegetation projects, and **homeowner incentives for creating defensible space and hardening homes**. The homeowner-facing mechanism was not yet published at research time.

WHAT SIXFOLD DOES WITH IT

Watch this one — it is the clearest sign that CWDG money is turning into homeowner cost-share on the Front Range. Check JeffCo's wildfire pages before quoting a foothills job.

Other counties with programs on record

CONFIRM TERMS FIRST-PARTY BEFORE RELYING ON ANY FIGURE

- **Delta County** (West Region Wildfire Council) — a Vegetation Management Cost-Share reported to reimburse **up to 75%** of defensible space, thinning and vegetation management on private property. West Slope; verify current cap and geography.
- **Boulder Mountain Fire, Golden Gate Fire and other Front Range mountain fire districts** — periodic district-run chipping and mitigation-grant offers, funded from CWDG/FRWRM pass-through. District by district, year by year.
- **La Plata / SW counties** — covered by WAP above.

TIER 3 Grants that fund the work at scale — Sixfold is the hired contractor, not the applicant

These do not pay individual homeowners. An HOA, fire district, water provider, county or nonprofit applies, wins the grant, and hires a contractor to do the work. For Sixfold this tier is a business-development channel: court the entities that can apply, and be the crew they name in the application.

CSFS Forest Restoration & Wildfire Risk Mitigation grant (FRWRM)

COLORADO STATE FOREST SERVICE · CSFS.COLOSTATE.EDU/GRANTS

The state's main competitive fuels-reduction grant. Roughly **$7.04M available for the 2026–27 cycle**, application window **3 August – 8 October 2026** (pre-award notifications February 2027, projects complete by March 2031). Funds defensible-space creation, mechanical thinning, prescribed fire, **slash disposal**, replanting and restoration, plus a capacity-building track (staffing, equipment, CWPP writing).

WHO CAN APPLY	Community groups and HOAs, local governments, fire districts, public/private utilities and water providers, state agencies, tribes, and fuels-reduction nonprofits. **An individual homeowner cannot apply alone** — only in collaboration with an eligible entity and only where the project benefits more than their own property.
MATCH	Minimum **1:1 (50%)**; reduced to **25% match (75% grant)** in areas with fewer economic resources. Cash, in-kind, equipment and volunteer labor count toward match.
CONTRACTORS	Not eligible to apply, but hired by the applicant to do the work.

WHAT SIXFOLD DOES WITH IT

The HOA/fire-district-board version of the funding one-pager is aimed at exactly this audience, and the 8 October 2026 deadline makes it time-sensitive. Being an early named implementation partner in an application is how a new contractor gets landscape-scale volume.

USFS Community Wildfire Defense Grant (CWDG)

US FOREST SERVICE (BIL-FUNDED) · ADMINISTERED IN COLORADO BY CSFS

Federal grants to **at-risk communities**: local governments, tribes, and nonprofits (including HOAs) that assist such communities, plus state forestry agencies. Funds Community Wildfire Protection Plans and their implementation. Prioritises high/very-high hazard, low-income, and recently disaster-impacted communities. Recent Colorado awards have been large and multi-year — the Jefferson County Sheriff's $9.67M award (Tier 2 above) is a CWDG grant, and it is explicitly funding homeowner defensible-space incentives.

WHAT SIXFOLD DOES WITH IT

Same play as FRWRM — the money reaches homeowners only after a community entity wins it and builds a program. Track which Front Range counties and districts hold active CWDG awards.

FEMA Hazard Mitigation Assistance — HMGP and BRIC

FEMA, VIA COLORADO DHSEM AND A LOCAL-GOVERNMENT SUB-APPLICANT

The **Hazard Mitigation Grant Program** becomes available after a presidential disaster declaration and can fund wildfire mitigation — including coordinated defensible space across many parcels and fuel breaks — through a state/local sub-applicant. **BRIC** (Building Resilient Infrastructure and Communities) is the competitive, non-disaster version. Neither takes a direct homeowner application; a county or municipality is the applicant.

WHAT SIXFOLD DOES WITH IT

Long lead times and heavy administration. Relevant only if a county Sixfold works in is running an HMGP-funded mitigation project and contracting the fieldwork.

Watershed and water-provider partnerships

DENVER WATER “FROM FORESTS TO FAUCETS”; NORTHERN WATER; COLORADO SPRINGS UTILITIES; AND OTHERS

Water providers co-fund forest treatment in the watersheds that feed their reservoirs. From Forests to Faucets (Denver Water with the US Forest Service, CSFS and NRCS) has put roughly **$96M** into more than **120,000 acres** since 2010, including on private land through partners. This is **landscape-scale work arranged through partnerships**, not a rebate a homeowner applies for — but a private parcel inside a priority watershed can sometimes be folded into a partner-led project.

WHAT SIXFOLD DOES WITH IT

If a job sits in a named source watershed, ask the county forester or CSFS field office whether a water-provider-funded project covers the area.

TIER 4 Federal cost-share and tax treatment for rural, agricultural and forest land

These reach an individual owner directly, but only if the land qualifies as working agricultural or non-industrial private forest land — not a typical WUI house lot. Worth raising with a client on acreage.

NRCS Environmental Quality Incentives Program (EQIP)

USDA NATURAL RESOURCES CONSERVATION SERVICE · LOCAL NRCS FIELD OFFICE / CONSERVATION DISTRICT

The only NRCS financial-assistance program that covers forestry resource concerns. Provides planning and cost-share payments to **agricultural producers and owners of non-industrial private forestland** (and tribes) for practices that reduce wildfire risk: **Brush Management (Practice 314)**, fuel-break construction, forest stand improvement, thinning and prescribed burning. Applications are accepted continuously with competitive ranking cutoffs; Colorado payment schedules are updated in the first quarter of each federal fiscal year.

LAND TEST — Cropland, rangeland, pastureland, non-industrial private forestland, or other farm/ranch land. A standard subdivided house lot generally does not qualify.

AMOUNT — Set by the Colorado practice payment schedule for each practice and scenario.

WHAT SIXFOLD DOES WITH IT

For a client with real acreage, “talk to your NRCS field office about EQIP before you schedule us” is a genuinely useful, no-risk thing to say.

CSFS Forest Ag Program — agricultural property-tax classification

COLORADO STATE FOREST SERVICE + COUNTY ASSESSOR · C.R.S. VIA HB90-1229

Not a rebate — a property-tax classification. An owner of **at least 40 forested acres** who has an approved forest management plan and manages the land to produce wood products for profit can have the land valued for property tax as agricultural land rather than residential/vacant, which is typically a large ongoing reduction. Apply with a completed forest management plan and inspection request by **1 October**; CSFS recommends eligible properties to the county assessor annually.

WHAT SIXFOLD DOES WITH IT

A thinning project done to a management plan can support the plan requirement. Mention it to large-acreage clients; it is a tax-status question for their assessor and a forester, not something Sixfold administers.

Ended, retired, or not what the name suggests

PROGRAM	STATUS	WHY IT'S HERE
Colorado Wildfire Resilient Homes Grant (DFPC home-hardening pilot)	**Repealed.** HB26-1395 ended the program effective 1 July 2026 and swept the fund balance to the General Fund. Last application period closed April 2024.	It still appears in older guides and contractor blogs as a live home-hardening grant. It is not.
State wildfire-mitigation income tax *subtraction* (DR 0104AD)	**Expired.** 100% for 2017–2019, then 50% for 2020–2024 (cap $2,500, WUI only). Not available for tax year 2025 onward.	Easy to confuse with the still-active *credit* (DR 0104CR). For 2023–24 a landowner could claim both; from 2025 only the credit remains.
HB23-1240 wildfire-disaster sales & use tax refund	**Active but unrelated.** Refunds sales/use tax on materials to *rebuild* a home destroyed in a declared wildfire disaster, 2020–2022.	It comes up in the same Department of Revenue pages as the mitigation credit. It has nothing to do with mitigation work and does not apply to Sixfold's clients.
“Strengthen Colorado Homes” (SB26-155)	**Different hazard.** Grants for *hail-resistant roof* retrofits on owner-occupied primary residences.	Sometimes cited alongside wildfire programs because it is also a roof-retrofit incentive. It is a hail program, not a wildfire one.

What this means for Sixfold

1. **Tier 1 is the universal pitch.** The state tax credit and the insurance discount apply to essentially every client regardless of county. They are the two things every rep and crew lead should be able to describe accurately, and the only funding Sixfold can point to on a first visit anywhere.
2. **Douglas County is the one local cheque worth chasing.** *Revised 2026-10-02:* the county's list is preferred, not required, so Sixfold can bid on cost-share jobs today. Getting onto the Preferred Contractor List still helps; never claim Sixfold is on it.
3. **El Paso County, where Sixfold is based, has the thinnest county-money picture.** Do not imply a local cost-share exists there until one is confirmed by name. Sell Tier 1.
4. **The grant tier (Tier 3) is a reason to court HOAs, fire districts and water providers**, not homeowners. The HOA/fire-district funding one-pager and the 8 October 2026 FRWRM deadline are the concrete openings.
5. **The stacking rule shapes how Sixfold talks about combining money.** "These can often be combined; your accountant can tell you how they interact" is safe. A worked example of grant-plus-credit on the same invoice is not — the credit cannot touch a dollar a grant already paid.
6. **Every number in this document is provisional.** Program caps, income limits, application windows and even whole programs change yearly. Re-verify against the primary source before any figure goes in front of a client or into a quote.

Fact-check log

CONFIRMED FIRST-PARTY OR AGAINST THE ENACTED STATUTE

- **State tax credit (C.R.S. 39-22-543).** Carried from the project's own verification: Colorado Dept of Revenue *Income Tax Topics: Wildfire Mitigation Measures* and *Wildfire Tax Benefits* (read in full 2026-08-21, browser user agent — the page 403s to a plain fetch); HB26-1289 Final Act amending the statute (read in full 2026-08-19); 2026 tax-expenditure evaluation 2026-TE4. Credit table 2023 $625 / 2024 $625 / 2025 $1,000 (FTI ≤ $129,200) / 2026 $1,000 (FTI TBD) / 2027–2030 $2,000 (AGI ≤ $300,000, refundable). Third-party-contractor-only since Aug 2024 (HB24-1036). Grant/incentive-funded costs excluded. One claimant per ownership group; recorded lease qualifies; no WUI test. New "infestation mitigation measures" category from 2027. Retired subtraction: 50% for 2020–2024, WUI only, $2,500 cap, DR 0104AD. HB23-1240 rebuild sales-tax refund is separate. See *tax-credit-notebook/README.md* for the full log and the unresolved points (2026 FTI limit unpublished; whether "AGI" in §(4)(c) is federal AGI; whether entity-owned land still qualifies from 2026).

- **HB25-1182** (insurance risk-model use), effective 1 July 2026 — annual written risk-score disclosure, disclosure of available discounts, parcel-level mitigation in scoring, a discount for documented mitigation even absent a formal model, right of appeal; no statutory discount percentage. (leg.colorado.gov/bills/hb25-1182; Colorado House/Senate Democrats joint release.) Colorado Division of Insurance Regulation 5-1-28 / 3 CCR 702-5 — draft text read 2026-10-02 (website posting of discounts with amounts or a statement of none; 30-day re-score; 10/30-day appeal; evidence incl. receipts, photos and contractor letters; admitted insurers and FAIR Plan only). **Effective date conflicts** (draft: 14 Feb 2026; ResourcePro summary: 1 Oct 2026) and is left out. Colorado FAIR Plan launched April 2025, up to $750,000 residential, actual-cash-value basis.
- **Douglas County Wildfire Mitigation Cost-Share** — 50% match, $25,000 home / $50,000 community / **$7,500** chipping (corrected 2026-10-02 from $7,000); a minimum of two bids, **preferably** from the county list — "Residents may choose any qualified contractor" (cost-share-contractors-aug-2026.pdf, read 2026-10-02) — plus scope and site map; **2026 round closed** as of 2026-10-02; county inspects on completion, homeowner pays their share, Douglas County Finance releases the 50% match directly to the contractor. (douglas.co.us/building-division/wildfire-mitigation and douglasco.gov/wildfires; Denver Gazette 2026-04-01; hoodline 2026-04.)
- **COSWAP landowner cost-share** — private landowners in the mapped area, free WAP risk assessment first, hire a contractor, reimbursed up to 50%; Feb 2026 workforce-development round $6.9M to 24 projects. (dnr.colorado.gov/co-strategic-wildfire-action-program; lpcgov.org/departments/emergency_management/coswap.php; Governor's Office release.)
- **Wildfire Partners (Boulder County)** — general rebate up to $500 per household/property, one per property, first-come, 2026 deadline 8 October 2026, ~$1.625M across rebate programs; multi-family up to $500 per unit for common areas. (wildfirepartners.org/rebate and /general-rebate-program; bouldercounty.gov news.) City of Boulder WRAP is a separate city program (bouldercolorado.gov/WRAP).
- **Grand County Wildfire Council** — Home Hardening Cost Share reimburses the lesser of $1,000 per property or 50%, after completion and full payment, first-come; HIZ assessment required; covers home hardening, first 5 ft, ⅛-in vent mesh. A separate Fuels Reduction Cost-Share exists. (bewildfireready.org/home-hardening and /programs/cost-share.)
- **Eagle County REALFire** — free assessment may qualify an owner for cost-share on a portion of the work; >$250,000 in awards to date; 750-home goal by 2028. (eaglecounty.us news; realfire.net.)
- **Wildfire Adapted Partnership Defensible Space Cost Share** — SW Colorado grant geography; free HIZ assessment, signed award letter before work, homeowner reimbursed after paying in full, amount set by site size/vegetation/terrain; separate Chipper Rebate. (wildfireadapted.org/cost-share, /chipper-rebate, /all-programs.)

- **Larimer County Community Mitigation Grant** — community groups, HOAs, nonprofits only (not individuals); funds fuels reduction, community chipping/slash, firewood banks, equipment; 2026 performance period ends 2 November 2026. (larimer.gov/emergency/community-mitigation-grant-program; larimer.gov spotlight 2026-05-14.)
- **Routt County** — landowners along evacuation corridors pay up front, 50% reimbursed via state (FRWRM) grant; 2026 budget up to ~$120,000 county-wide, $60,000 state-reimbursed, plus $10,000 from the Wildfire Mitigation Council. (SteamboatToday / Steamboat Pilot, 2026.)
- **Summit County** — free chipping and haul-away of slash piles (trees/logs/branches ≤ 12 in, no willows) on a neighbourhood-week schedule; free fire-district assessments; CWPP matching grants for life-safety/infrastructure/evacuation/education, not routine defensible space. (summitcountyco.gov CSU Extension forest-health / wildfire-programs.)
- **CSFS FRWRM grant** — ~$7.04M for 2026–27, application 3 Aug – 8 Oct 2026, pre-awards 10 Feb 2027, complete by 31 Mar 2031; eligible applicants are community groups/HOAs, local governments, fire districts, utilities/water providers, state agencies, tribes, nonprofits — homeowners only in collaboration with an eligible entity and with benefits beyond their own property; 1:1 match, reduced to 25% in under-resourced areas; funds defensible space, thinning, prescribed fire, slash disposal, replanting, capacity building. (csfs.colostate.edu/grants/forest-restoration-wildfire-risk-mitigation.)
- **USFS Community Wildfire Defense Grant** — eligible applicants are local governments, tribes, nonprofits (incl. HOAs) assisting at-risk communities, and state forestry agencies; funds CWPPs and implementation; prioritises high-hazard, low-income and disaster-impacted communities; administered in Colorado by CSFS; Round 3 closed 11 March 2025. Jefferson County Sheriff's Office awarded $9,668,390 (announced July 2026) to fund staff, equipment, roadside projects and homeowner defensible-space/home-hardening incentives. (fs.usda.gov/managing-land/fire/grants/cwdg; csfs.colostate.edu/grants/cwdg; Denver Gazette / KKTV 2026-07.)
- **NRCS EQIP** — eligible: agricultural producers, owners of non-industrial private forestland, tribes; eligible land: cropland, rangeland, pastureland, NIPF; wildfire practices include Brush Management (314), fuel breaks, forest stand improvement, thinning, prescribed burn; continuous application with ranking cutoffs; CO payment schedules updated Q1 each fiscal year. (nrcs.usda.gov EQIP Colorado; Fire Adapted Communities Learning Network.)
- **CSFS Forest Ag Program** — agricultural property-tax valuation for ≥ 40 forested acres with an approved forest management plan managed for wood-product profit; apply by 1 October; CSFS recommends to the county assessor annually; enacted by HB90-1229. (csfs.colostate.edu/forest-ag-program.)
- **Colorado Wildfire Resilient Homes Grant repealed** — HB26-1395, effective 1 July 2026, fund balance transferred to the General Fund on 30 June 2026; House passed 11 April 2026, Senate 16 April 2026. (leg.colorado.gov/bills/HB26-1395; LegiScan.)

- **From Forests to Faucets** — Denver Water with USFS, CSFS and NRCS; ~$96M invested, 120,000+ acres treated 2010 through work planned to 2027; explicitly includes private land through partners. (denverwater.org watershed-protection pages; csfs.colostate.edu.)

REPORTED BUT NOT CONFIRMED FIRST-PARTY — VERIFY BEFORE USE

- **Delta County / West Region Wildfire Council Vegetation Management Cost-Share — "up to 75%".** Appears in a secondary summary (Smart Home America). Confirm the percentage, cap and geography with the West Region Wildfire Council before repeating it.
- **"El Paso County offers cost-share grants".** Stated only by contractor-marketing sites (defensiblehome.com and similar). No El Paso County program page was found. Treated in the body as unconfirmed and something to check by phone.
- **Grand County Fuels Reduction Cost-Share terms.** The dedicated page returned a 404 at research time; only the Home Hardening pot's numbers are confirmed.

NOT OBTAINED — NEEDS A CALL OR A FRESH CHECK

- The 2026 federal-taxable-income limit for the state credit (Revenue lists it as TBD).
- ~~Douglas County's approved-contractor-list requirements~~ — *resolved 2026-10-02:* the list is preferred, not required. Still unknown: how a contractor gets onto the Preferred list, and the date of the next round.
- Whether any El Paso County, Teller County, or their fire districts (Black Forest Fire, Tri-Lakes-Monument Fire, Woodland Park / NE Teller) run a current homeowner mitigation rebate funded by CWDG or FRWRM pass-through.
- Jefferson County's homeowner-incentive mechanism under its new $9.67M CWDG award — not yet published.
- Whether DFPC still runs any "Home Hardening Grant" distinct from the repealed Wildfire Resilient Homes Grant — the DFPC grants page 403s to automated fetch.
- Current-cycle COSWAP program-area maps — change each round.
- City of Boulder WRAP terms and caps.

STRUCTURAL NOTES

- **The stacking exclusion is the load-bearing fact.** C.R.S. 39-22-543 excludes any cost paid from or reimbursed by a grant or incentive, so grant money and the state credit cannot both apply to the same dollar. This is verified project knowledge, not new research.
- Most Tier-2 programs follow one pattern: *free assessment first → signed award before work → homeowner pays in full → partial reimbursement to the homeowner*. Douglas County is the notable exception (pays the contractor directly).
- Nearly every county and rebate pot is **first-come until exhausted** and reopens on an annual cycle — a "yes" in spring can be a "closed" by August.

- Sixfold's role across all of this is documentation and referral, never administration: no returns filed, no certifications issued, no insurer contacted, no discount or reimbursement amount promised. The banned phrase remains *"we handle the paperwork for you."*

Sources

- State tax credit — Colorado Dept of Revenue, *Income Tax Topics: Wildfire Mitigation Measures* and *Wildfire Tax Benefits*; HB26-1289 Final Act (leg.colorado.gov bill file 116779) amending C.R.S. 39-22-543; 2026 tax-expenditure evaluation 2026-TE4 (content.leg.colorado.gov). Full working notes: *sixfold/tax-credit-notebook/README.md*, *sixfold/content/02-tax-credit-post.md*.
- Insurance — leg.colorado.gov/bills/hb25-1182 ; cohousedems.com / senatedems.co joint release ; ilsainc.com and resourcepro compliance bulletin on the DOI disclosure regulation ; Colorado FAIR Plan (coloradofairplan.com background via secondary coverage).
- Douglas County — douglas.co.us/building-division/wildfire-mitigation/wildfire-mitigation-cost-share-program/ ; douglasco.gov/wildfires/wildfire-mitigation-cost-share-program/ ; denvergazette.com 2026-04-01 ; hoodline.com 2026-04.
- COSWAP — dnr.colorado.gov/co-strategic-wildfire-action-program ; lpcgov.org/departments/emergency_management/coswap.php ; governorsoffice.colorado.gov.
- Wildfire Partners — wildfirepartners.org/rebate/ ; wildfirepartners.org/general-rebate-program/ ; bouldercounty.gov/news ; bouldercolorado.gov/WRAP.
- Grand County Wildfire Council — bewildfireready.org/home-hardening ; bewildfireready.org/programs/cost-share ; bewildfireready.org/news/207-colorado-wildfire-resilient-homes-grant.
- Eagle County — eaglecounty.us/news_detail_T24_R607.php ; realfire.net.
- Wildfire Adapted Partnership — wildfireadapted.org/cost-share ; wildfireadapted.org/chipper-rebate ; wildfireadapted.org/all-programs.
- Larimer County — larimer.gov/emergency/community-mitigation-grant-program ; larimer.gov/spotlights/2026/05/14/2026-community-mitigation-grant-award-recipients ; larimer.gov/sheriff/support-services/emergency-services/wpp.
- Routt County — steamboatpilot.com 2026 (evacuation-corridor mitigation program coverage).
- Summit County — summitcountyco.gov/services/community_development/csu_extension/forest_health/wildfire_programs.php ; townofblueriver.colorado.gov/summit-county-slash-program.
- CSFS FRWRM — csfs.colostate.edu/grants/forest-restoration-wildfire-risk-mitigation/ ; csfs.colostate.edu/grants/.
- CWDG — fs.usda.gov/managing-land/fire/grants/cwdg ; fs.usda.gov/managing-land/fire/grants/cwdg/how-to-apply ; csfs.colostate.edu/grants/cwdg/ ; denvergazette.com 2026-07-10 ; kktv.com 2026-07-09.
- FEMA HMA — fema.gov/locations/risk-reduction/colorado ; dhsem.colorado.gov.
- NRCS EQIP — nrcs.usda.gov/programs-initiatives/environmental-quality-incentives-program/colorado ; nrcs.usda.gov/conservation-basics/conservation-state/colorado/payment-schedule ; fireadaptednetwork.org (USDA-NRCS wildfire assistance overview).

- Forest Ag Program — csfs.colostate.edu/forest-ag-program/ ; jeffco.us landowner forest-management-plan guidelines.
- HB26-1395 repeal — leg.colorado.gov/bills/HB26-1395 ; legiscan.com/CO/bill/HB1395/2026.
- From Forests to Faucets — denverwater.org/your-water/water-supply-and-planning/watershed-protection-and-management ; csfs.colostate.edu.
- Jefferson County landowner assistance — jeffco.us FAQ “Forest Management and Fire Mitigation for Landowners” ; jcd.colorado.gov (Jefferson Conservation District).

Sixfold LLC — internal operations reference — prepared 2026-09-08, revised 2026-10-02 — not tax or legal advice — not for customer distribution — every figure to be re-verified against its primary source before it is used with a client.